Trafford Fewster

Software Engineer

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SUMMARY

Results-driven Software Engineer with extensive experience across PHP (Laravel) backends, REST APIs and modern web technologies, supported by deep expertise in AWS infrastructure and DevOps workflows. Proven ability to lead the technical breakdown of complex features, trace difficult problems across service boundaries, and keep cross-functional teams aligned through delivery. Works spec-first with generative AI tooling and ships incrementally behind feature flags.

SKILLS

Development: PHP (Laravel & Yii), CraftCMS, JavaScript, Vue, Nuxt, CSS & Tailwind

Backend & APIs: REST API development, serverless services, service-to-service integration

Database & Search: MySQL, DynamoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch & Algolia

Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, Lambda, RDS, S3, Route53, WAF & Cloudfront) & Cloudflare

DevOps: Python, GitHub Actions, feature flags & incremental release

Testing: PHPUnit & Vitest (Jest syntax)

AI Tools: Claude & OpenSpec (spec-driven development)

Tools: Composer, NPM & Prettier

EXPERIENCE

CAVU

February 2025 - Present | PHP Engineer

- Directed the technical breakdown for a new feature, defining and coordinating all required engineering tasks with the team.
- Facilitated cross-team communication and planning to ensure service owners remained aligned with upcoming feature changes.
- Reduced internal order search response times from over 30 seconds to under 2 by removing a cross-service call that triggered a full DynamoDB scan, denormalising the required user fields into the booking Elasticsearch index instead.
- Diagnosed an intermittent status update failure reported with no clear pattern or reproduction steps, tracing it to a 24 hour document review lockout being applied to the admin upload path where it did not belong.
- Implemented feature flags and per-region rollout to ensure the safe and controlled release of all new system functionality.
- Conducted research spikes into technical unknowns and produced documentation for both technical and non-technical stakeholders.
- Adopted spec-driven development using OpenSpec with Claude, agreeing requirements and change proposals up front so implementation follows a versioned spec rather than a chat thread.

Payment Assist LTD

February 2024 - January 2025 | Software Developer

- Reworked frontend assets to use a JavaScript build process, removing duplicate source code for a much better developer experience and reducing frontend bundle size through built-in minification.
- Updated a model to work using an EAV model rather than a JSON SQL field.
- Improved automated test coverage in a large critical code base by 10%.
- Started re-writing our auth solution to be more centralized and support modern standards such as pass keys.

DestinationCore

March 2023 - January 2024 | Software Engineer

- Rebuilt our business login Craft CMS plugin allowing hundreds of individual businesses to maintain their page content with a review process for the site admins.
- Maintained and added connections to our Laravel serverless Availability Search Engine, a REST API providing users with more options and details when looking for accommodation or experiences on our sites.
- Supported outsourced development resources with any problems they had with our projects or infrastructure.

January 2022 - March 2023 | Junior Full-Stack Developer

- Created and maintained multiple Craft CMS websites (Visit Peak District, Newcastle New Adventures, Visit York).
- Improved performance by around 20% through investigation of queries and implementation of strict eager loading.
- Developed the JavaScript front end for our in-house availability search, consuming our search API so users could view the availability of properties or experiences at the destination.
- Helped coach other Junior developers to bring them up to speed with our code bases and processes.

Netmatters

March 2021 - January 2022 | Trainee Web Developer

- Completed intensive, tailored training program under the guidance of senior web developers.
- Studied front-end and back-end development, including UI/UX design, object-oriented programming, and databases.
- Created company and employee portal in Laravel with the ability to assign employees to companies and edit properties.
- Recreated Netmatters homepage using HTML and CSS, showcasing various features and methods.

Jungle Servers

February 2018 - December 2020 | Founder/Developer

- Gained hands-on experience developing and monetising a production product.
- Led a team of volunteers responsible for moderating the server and providing support to users.
- Communicated with users about upcoming changes and received feedback.
- Implemented changes and updates based on user feedback to improve the product and user experience.

PROJECTS

You can find a list of projects I have worked on on my portfolio @ https://trafford.dev